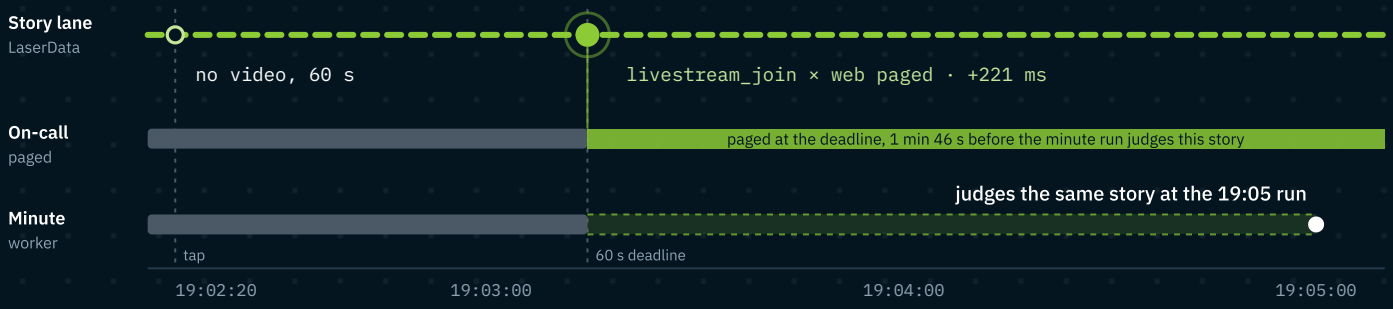
laserdata

Prepared for **Whatnot**

Real-time livestream SLOs for Whatnot, on LaserData.

Every story event reaches **the story judge in milliseconds**, so a livestream join is judged the moment its last outcome lands or its deadline passes. It runs beside Kafka and ClickHouse, so nothing else has to move.

One livestream join,
as the event log sees it.
Now multiply by 30 core features.




```
19:02:14.208   livestream_tile_tap   story 7f3a91c2   web   cl-0418827
19:02:15.116   join_authorized · auction_shown · chat_visible   no video_playing
19:03:14.427   story failed          missing video_playing   web SLI 94.1% of 186 clients
19:03:14.429   slo.alert            pager, Datadog, incident bot   +2 ms
```

From the creators of APACHE IGGY

15×
faster P99 latency
than Apache Kafka

4×
higher throughput
than Apache Kafka

60–70%
lower infrastructure cost
compute, storage and network

Apache Iggy vs Apache Kafka, LaserData testing. Results vary by workload.

What you shared	**E2E SLO stories** (video, auction and chat for a livestream join) go through Kafka to ClickHouse, judged **once a minute** against a 60-second deadline. The June 8 black screen hit **3,000 users in 30 minutes** while dashboards stayed green; story volume is pushing minute-based ClickHouse queries to their limit, so "stream processing is our next step". (Whatnot Engineering, Sep 2026)
Where it fits	**The story SLO lane:** story events keyed by story key into the story judge, SLO alerts out to the pager, Datadog and the incident bot. Kafka, ClickHouse and the minute worker stay.
Next	**Incident agents** act on the same lane, with session, context, memory and replay from Laser SDK.
Underneath	**One durable event log.** LaserData, powered by Apache Iggy.

Try it in 15 minutes. Let the numbers decide.

A ready-made kit for Whatnot: **200,000 clients joining livestreams and bidding**, events delivered twice, a black screen on web, client telemetry next door and a Kafka shadow bridge. It prints your lane's p99, every SLI and when on-call gets the page, every second.

Open the Whatnot kit and write-up →

Then a 2–4 week evaluation on one mirrored story events topic, alongside Kafka and ClickHouse. **No advantage, no migration.**

kranti@laserdata.com laserdata.com

© 2026 LaserData, Inc. Apache, Apache Iggy and the Iggy logo are trademarks of The Apache Software Foundation; their use does not imply endorsement by the ASF. The Whatnot name identifies the intended reader only; no affiliation is implied. Facts are from Whatnot Engineering's posts "All Dashboards Green, All Screens Black" (September 15, 2026) and "Scaling our Data Stack with Kafka and Real-Time Stream Processing" (2022) and its public job postings. Story key, client, timestamps, SLI figures and the alert timing are illustrative.